Trustee AI Oversight Assessment

Deterministic governance assessment · full result

Riverside Community Trust (fictional)

16/10/2026

🟠 Developing

This assessment identified evidence of good governance across several trustee duties. The findings also highlight specific governance gaps that can be strengthened before they become issues a funder or regulator raises. The breakdown below shows exactly where.

This result suggests parts of your AI oversight may be difficult to evidence if questioned by regulators, funders, or auditors.

OVERALL GOVERNANCE SCORE

48%

Developing

20 of 42 points scored

ASSESSMENT METHOD

This assessment evaluates trustee oversight against six governance duties synthesised from the Charity Governance Code, Charity Commission trustee guidance, and ICO AI and data protection guidance.

How this result was produced. *Your answers are scored against a fixed rules model, not judged individually by a person. The same answers always produce the same result, and nothing here is edited by hand.*

This screening is based solely on the answers provided and does not imply that governance does not exist elsewhere in the charity.

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01 Board summary

Overall status: 🟠 Developing

Top 3 risks

• Ongoing Review: Evidence missing — A spot-check process exists to confirm actual AI use matches the written policy.

• Named Accountability: Evidence missing — AI is listed by name on our risk register, not lumped in with general IT risk.

• Transparency & Disclosure: Evidence missing — We tell beneficiaries or donors when AI is involved in something that affects them.

Top 3 actions

☐ Action required: Set up a spot-check process to confirm actual AI use matches the written policy.

☐ Action required: Add AI as a separate item on the board risk register.

☐ Action required: Add a disclosure step so beneficiaries or donors are told when AI is involved in something that affects them.

Recommended review date: 16/10/2027

02 Methodology

This result is deterministic: the same answers always produce the same verdict. Each finding below carries the specific source it is grounded in, so you can check it against the sector's own published standards rather than take this report's word for it.

03 Dimension summary

Duty	Score	Status
Named Accountability	37.5%	**Gap**
Transparency & Disclosure	37.5%	**Gap**

Data Protection & Safety	62.5%	**Developing**
Fairness & Safeguarding	66.7%	**Developing**
Redress & Human Oversight	50.0%	**Developing**
Ongoing Review	33.3%	**Gap**

Top priorities

- Ongoing Review (33.3%, Gap)
- Named Accountability (37.5%, Gap)
- Transparency & Disclosure (37.5%, Gap)

04 Named Accountability: Who owns AI?

37.5% (3 of 8) **Gap**

Finding	Answer	Source
One specific trustee, or a small group, is written down as being in charge of AI, not just "the board."	✔ **Evidence Found (informal)**	Charity Governance Code 2025
The board has formally discussed AI risks and recorded the outcome.	✔ **Evidence Found (documented)**	Charity Commission CC26 (Charities and risk management)
AI is listed by name on our risk register, not lumped in with general IT risk.	✖ **Evidence Missing**	Charity Commission CC26 (Charities and risk management)
At least one trustee has had some training on what AI means for their responsibilities as a trustee.	✖ **Evidence Missing**	Charity Governance Code 2025

05 Transparency & Disclosure: Can we explain our AI use?

37.5% (3 of 8) **Gap**

Finding	Answer	Source
We have a written AI policy that covers every AI tool we use, not just the obvious ones like ChatGPT.	✔ **Evidence Found (informal)**	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework
We tell beneficiaries or donors when AI is involved in something that affects them.	✖ **Evidence Missing**	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework
Our AI policy has a scheduled review date.	✔ **Evidence Found (documented)**	Charity Governance Code 2025
We've checked which of our	✖ **Evidence Missing**	Fundraising Regulator, Guidance

existing platforms (advertising, CRM, email, website, office software) have AI features switched on that can create content or act in our name, and approved or switched off each one.		for using artificial intelligence in fundraising (Dec 2025)

06 Data Protection & Safety: Do we know what data it touches?

62.5% (5 of 8) **Developing**

Finding	Answer	Source
We know the legal reason we're allowed to put people's personal data into an AI tool.	✔ Evidence Found (documented)	ICO guidance on AI and data protection
We've checked whether any of our AI tools need a more detailed data protection risk assessment.	✔ Evidence Found (documented)	ICO guidance on AI and data protection
We have signed agreements with our AI suppliers covering how they handle our data.	✖ Evidence Missing	ICO guidance on AI and data protection
Only approved AI tools are used.	✔ Evidence Found (informal)	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework

07 Fairness & Safeguarding: Are vulnerable beneficiaries protected?

66.7% (4 of 6) **Developing**

Finding	Answer	Source
We've checked our AI use doesn't unfairly affect the people we work with, including children, adults at risk, and groups protected under the Equality Act.	✔ Evidence Found (documented)	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework
Potential impacts on beneficiaries have been considered before using AI.	✔ Evidence Found (documented)	Charity Commission CC3 (The essential trustee)
If we use AI-generated images, we have safeguards against deepfakes or misleading pictures.	✖ Evidence Missing	Charity Commission CC3 (The essential trustee); CC20 where images are used in fundraising; Fundraising Regulator guidance on AI in fundraising (Dec 2025)

08 Redress & Human Oversight: Can someone challenge an AI decision?

50.0% (3 of 6)	Developing

Finding	Answer	Source
There's a clear way for someone to complain or raise a concern if AI causes a problem.	✔ Evidence Found (documented)	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework
We keep records of important AI-assisted decisions.	✔ Evidence Found (informal)	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework
Staff and volunteers know how to spot AI problems, like fake images, impersonation, or factual mistakes.	✖ Evidence Missing	Charity Excellence AI Governance & Ethics Framework

09 Ongoing Review: Do we keep this under review?

33.3% (2 of 6)	Gap

Finding	Answer	Source
The AI policy and risk assessment have a confirmed next review date.	✔ Evidence Found (documented)	Charity Governance Code 2025
A spot-check process exists to confirm actual AI use matches the written policy.	✖ Evidence Missing	Charity Governance Code 2025
The charity could produce a funder- or Commission-ready summary of AI tools and data flows within 48 hours.	✖ Evidence Missing	Charity Commission CC3 (The essential trustee)

10 Sources

This check draws on the Charity Governance Code 2025, the Charity Digital Code of Practice 2025, the ICO's guidance on AI and data protection, and published sector frameworks including Charity Excellence's AI Governance and Ethics Framework. Questions are written independently and are not endorsed by these bodies.

Governance is not a one-off exercise. Revisit this assessment annually, or whenever your charity adopts a new AI tool.

This assessment is an educational governance screening and should not be interpreted as legal or regulatory advice.